Row, Row, Row Your Boat

1881 round · Four phrases

Sing all four lines together first. Then sing as a round.

Lyrics

Row, row, row your boat,

Gently down the stream;

Merrily, merrily, merrily, merrily;

Life is but a dream.

LEADER NOTE

Divide into two to four groups. Group 1 begins. Group 2 starts at 'Row' when Group 1 reaches 'Gently'; Group 3 when Group 1 reaches 'Merrily'; Group 4 when Group 1 reaches 'Life.' Repeat the four lines. On the leader's last-pass cue, each group finishes its own four lines.

My Bonnie

1915 songbook version · Four verses and chorus

Start with Verse 1. Sing the chorus after each verse, including Verse 4.

Verse 1

My Bonnie is over the ocean,
My Bonnie is over the sea,
My Bonnie is over the ocean,
O bring back my Bonnie to me.

Chorus

Bring back, bring back,
Bring back my Bonnie to me, to me;
Bring back, bring back,
O bring back my Bonnie to me.

Verse 2

O blow, ye winds, over the ocean,
And blow, ye winds, over the sea,
O blow, ye winds, over the ocean,
And bring back my Bonnie to me.

Verse 3

Last night as I lay on my pillow,
Last night as I lay on my bed,
Last night as I lay on my pillow,
I dreamed that my Bonnie was dead.

Verse 4

The winds have blown over the ocean,
The winds have blown over the sea,
The winds have blown over the ocean,
And bro't back my Bonnie to me.

LEADER NOTE

Sing to the familiar My Bonnie tune. For the traditional B-word action, start seated; stand or sit each time you sing a word beginning with B. Practice slowly, especially 'bring back my Bonnie.'

Scotland's Burning

1915 round · Four phrases

Sing all four lines together first. Then sing as a round.

Lyrics

Scotland's burning, Scotland's burning,

Look out, look out!

Fire, fire, fire, fire!

Pour on water, Pour on water.

LEADER NOTE

Divide into two to four groups. Group 1 begins. Group 2 starts at 'Scotland's burning' when Group 1 reaches 'Look out'; Group 3 when Group 1 reaches 'Fire'; Group 4 when Group 1 reaches 'Pour on water.' Repeat the four lines. On the leader's last-pass cue, each group finishes its own four lines.

She'll Be Comin' Round the Mountain

1927 songbook version · Three verses

Sing Verses 1-3 in order. 'When she comes' is part of each verse; there is no separate chorus.

Verse 1

She'll be comin' round the mountain,
When she comes.
She'll be comin' round the mountain,
When she comes.
She'll be comin' round the mountain,
She'll be comin' round the mountain,
She'll be comin' round the mountain,
When she comes.

Verse 2

She'll be drivin' six white horses,
When she comes.
She'll be drivin' six white horses,
When she comes.
She'll be drivin' six white horses,
She'll be drivin' six white horses,
She'll be drivin' six white horses,
When she comes.

Verse 3

Oh we'll all go to meet her,
When she comes.
Oh we'll all go to meet her,
When she comes.
We will kill the old red rooster,
We will kill the old red rooster,
And we'll all have chicken and dumplin',
When she comes.

LEADER NOTE

Use the familiar mountain-song tune and keep a steady beat. In Verse 3, the words change halfway through: meet her, red rooster, then chicken and dumplin'.